

Year 3 Science: Living and Non-Living Things

Identify features of living things and compare them with non-living things.

Name: _____

Date: _____

Learning Intention

I can explain how living things are different from non-living things.

Success Criteria

I can list features of living things, sort examples, and explain my thinking.

A. Warm Up - Sort It

Write L for living and N for non-living.

1. gum tree ____
2. rock ____
3. kangaroo ____
4. water bottle ____
5. mushroom ____
6. toy car ____

B. Living Thing Clues

Tick the clues that show something is living.

- ☐ It grows and changes
- ☐ It needs air, water or food
- ☐ It can reproduce
- ☐ It is made of plastic
- ☐ It responds to its environment

C. Explain Your Thinking

1. A seed is small and does not move. Is it living? Explain.

2. A robot can move and make sounds. Is it living? Explain.

3. Choose one living thing. Write two needs it has.

D. True or False

1. All living things need water. ____
2. A rock can grow by itself. ____
3. Plants are living things. ____
4. Fire is a living thing. ____

E. Challenge

Draw or name one thing from your home. Decide if it is living or non-living and give one reason.

Thing: _____

Reason: _____

Answer Key: Living and Non-Living Things

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Complete Answer Key

A. 1 L, 2 N, 3 L, 4 N, 5 L, 6 N.

B. Tick: It grows and changes; It needs air, water or food; It can reproduce; It responds to its environment.

C. 1. Yes. A seed is living because it can grow into a plant when conditions are right. 2. No. A robot is made by people and does not grow, reproduce or need food/water like living things. 3. Answers vary, e.g. a bird needs food and water.

D. 1 True, 2 False, 3 True, 4 False.

E. Answers vary. Accept clear classification with a reason.

Parent/Teacher Tip: Ask students to justify each sort using evidence, not just name the object.